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SPORTS BUSINESS MANAGEMENT **“SPORTS”**

Syllabus

Content

This course applies business concepts that you have learned during the MBA program to the industry of sports. This industry is very diverse ranging from sports as leisure to professional sports, from events such as a World Cup or the Olympic Games to the leagues at the local level, from individual sports to team sports, from profit-making products to agents of social change. Each sport has its particular features and the various actors—such as players, coaches, fans, team managers, league managers, media, equipment providers, sponsors, and governments—play different roles. Each sport can be analyzed at different levels from leagues and tournaments at the top going through teams, events, and individual players. At each level and across levels, the actors of sport interact to create value and allocate the value created.

“SPORTS” has three objectives. First and foremost, the course aims to give participants insights into the sports industry, especially from a managers’ perspective. Secondly, the course will provide participants with a platform to integrate knowledge from other parts of the MBA program. Third, “SPORTS” will give industry insights that can be applied in other industries.

Reading Materials

All **cases** are provided and reading them and preparing for the sessions is **mandatory**.

For participants who want to dig deeper into the subject I recommend: **Sports Business Management, G. Foster, N. O’Reilly, A. Davila, Routledge, 2nd Ed., 2021, ISBN: 978-0-367-35606-4.**

Assistance, Participation and Grading

Assistance is mandatory. This course is dynamic with strong participation from the participants. Therefore 40% of the grade will be based on class participation. The remaining 60% will be dependent on 2 assignments. Maximum 750 words/assignment. You can choose from any of these combos (no mixing). DETERMINE WHAT THE SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT ISSUE OF THE CASE IS AND PROVIDE SOLUTIONS

- **Combo #1:** Brita's Stephen Curry Sponsorship Splash, The National Football League and Brain Injuries
- **Combo #2:** *IJCSM Internationalizing a Sports Agency (A), The Indian Premier League 2020*
- **Combo #3:** Negotiating for Equal Pay, The Globalization of Manchester City

Assignments must be put on Blackboard **before the start** of the relevant session and this assignment is **individual** as well as **authentic**. I.e. I expect your observations (not of someone else, nor any generative pre-trained platform such as Chat GPT).

I expect you to explain the core issues as well as how you would have tackled them.

Competences

Basic

CB7. The students know how to apply the knowledge acquired and their ability to solve problems in new or unfamiliar environments within broader (or multidisciplinary) contexts related to their area of study.

CB8. The students can integrate knowledge and face the complexity of formulating judgments based on information that, being incomplete or limited, includes reflections on social and ethical responsibilities linked to the application of their knowledge and judgments.

CB9. Students know how to communicate their conclusions and the knowledge and ultimate reasons that support them to specialized and non-specialized audiences in a clear and unambiguous way.

CB10. Students possess the learning skills that allow them to continue studying in a way that will be largely self-directed or autonomous.

General

CG5. Show entrepreneurial behavior, initiating and promoting the necessary changes with energy and personal responsibility.

CG6. Prioritize objectives, schedule activities appropriately, and execute them within the scheduled time.

CG7. Identify and deal effectively with information relevant to their work.

Specific

CE01. Apply a structured and rigorous process of analysis of business situations and decision making that incorporates the following phases: diagnosis of the problem, selection of criteria, identification of alternatives, weighted analysis, and identifying an alternative with its consequent action plan.

CE02. Prepare structured, synthetic, and clear executive reports for the analysis and decision-making of business situations.

CE06. Adopt an anthropological and sociological model based on academic studies that explain organizational behaviour and emphasis concepts of motivation, trust, authority, power, and commitment. Guide the model to analysis and action in the organization of work, management styles, and the creation of company cultures.

CE08. Acquire coaching skills to identify and develop talent in the members of an organization. Learn techniques to give and receive feedback, observe and measure skills, and facilitate their development through the design of work experiences.

CE09. Design or improve work relations and policies. Understand the evaluation and incentive systems, promotion, development, training, organizational culture, and the role of the different agents inside and outside the organization that affects work relations.

CE12. Assume the criteria and rules for the ethical analysis of decisions as their own. Know the traditional ethical thought systems and develop a critical spirit about their advantages and disadvantages. Develop the ethical sense in any decision-making in the organization. Understand the existing incentives around these decisions.

CE22. Estimate the operational needs of funds and choose the most appropriate financial products for their financing: credit policies, factoring, confirming, terms of collection and payment with customers and suppliers, etc.

CE23. Optimize capital structures to maximize the value of the company and develop a critical sense to relativize estimates and identify risk and sensitivity factors.

Professor's Biography



Prof. Jan Simon

Professor of the Practice of Management of Entrepreneurship

Jan Simon is Professor of the Practice of Management in Entrepreneurship at IESE and the Academic Director of its International Search Fund Center.

Jan worked over two decades in the investment industry. He co-headed the Emerging Markets Trading Desk at Salomon Brothers, set up the Continental Sales-Trading Desk at Goldman Sachs, and was a member of Merrill Lynch's Hedge Fund Advisory Group. He has been a Special Advisor to Pacific Lake Partners and is the Managing Partner of Vonzeo Capital, a global institutional investor in search funds.

His expertise is in the areas of investment strategies, mergers and acquisitions, entrepreneurial acquisitions and sports management. He has managed money in equities, fixed income, search funds, and advised hedge funds in a variety of strategies. His research has been published in academic journals such as the Journal of Network Theory in Finance and the British Journal of Management.

Jan holds an LL.B. and LL.M. from the Katholieke Universiteit Leuven, an MBA from IESE Business School, earned his Ph.D. in Finance from the University of Essex, holds the ICD.D Designation for Corporate Directors from the Rotman School of Management, and earned his AMP at Harvard Business School.

He served the 1st Battalion of Parachutists and Commandos -Special Operations Regiment-, as well as NATO's Special Intervention Forces -ACE Mobile Force-. Jan holds both the green and red beret. He played water polo internationally.

Course outline

Session 1

Topic: The Structure of Sports

Sport: College Sports

Region: Canada and USA

Case: Ivey – W14102 – The monopolistic power of the NCAA

Questions for the case:

1. Explain the disparity among the ‘haves’ and ‘have-nots’ in college athletics.
2. Explain how NCAA bylaws on amateurism and its core values based on education are linked.
3. Explain the ramifications for the NCAA if the wealthiest and most pedigreed college athletic programs split away from the NCAA and formed their own league and rules of governance.
4. How should Marc Emmert position the NCAA in order to provide a sustainable business model to its member institutions?

Session 2

Topic: The Sports Industry

Sport: Golf

Region: World

Case: IJCSM Internationalizing a Sports Agency (A), Volume 18, issue 1, 03/20

Questions for the case:

1. Assess Pro-G’s entry into the US Market.
2. Would you let Schmidt continue with business as usual, replace him, or try to manage him? Formulate an action plan to deal with the situation.
3. Any observations concerning Pro-G’s strategy in general?

Session 3

Topic: Sport Leagues, Value Creation and Business Model

Sport: Ice Hockey

Region: Canada and USA

Case: IJCSM, The National Hockey League (NHL), Volume 18, issue 2, 06/20

Questions for the case:

1. Is the NHL a professional sports league that stands out today?
2. What is the NHL's biggest strength? What are its weaknesses?
3. Craft an initial plan for future sustainable growth. What are its main elements?

Session 4

Topic: Sports, Innovation, and Digitalization

Sport: Tennis

Region: World

Case: IN2016, Infosys: Digital Innovation and Tennis (A)

Questions for the case:

1. Should Infosys consider expanding into partnerships in other sports? If so, which ones and how?
2. How could Infosys impact other organizations within the tennis ecosystem?
3. What other innovations could it explore with its current partners? Explain.
4. How can Infosys establish itself as the preferred technology provider for clients' digital transformation strategies through tennis partnerships?

Session 5

Topic: Sports and Entrepreneurship

Sport: Cricket

Region: India

Case: HBS 9-721-362 The Indian Premier League, 2020

Questions for the case:

1. Why do people watch sports? What do they want to see in a game?
2. What made the IPL so successful? Why?
3. Why are the team owners willing to be regulated? What did they learn from NFL?
4. What did they do? What did they not do
5. Do you see any further opportunities

Session 6

Topic: Sponsorship decisions

Sport: Basketball

Region: USA

Reading:

Case: NAO594 – Brita's Stephen Curry Sponsorship Splash

Questions for the case:

1. Who did Brita compete against for its chosen customers?
2. How did Brita position its brand relative to these alternatives?
3. To what extent was Curry a good fit for the Brita brand?
4. Based on your analysis, how should Kittredge use the Curry sponsorship to turn around the brand's market performance?

Session 7

Topic: Motivation and Incentives

Sport: Soccer

Region: USA

Case: HBS 9-920-029 Negotiating for Equal Pay: The US Women's National Soccer Team (A)

Questions for the case:

1. Was the compensation received by the US Women's National Soccer Team fair relative to the compensation received by the US Men's National Soccer Team? In general, what makes a compensation package fair?
2. Think about a time when your compensation was unfair. How did you react? If you have never had that experience, imagine how you would in such a situation.

Session 8

Topic: Leadership and Sports

Sport: Rowing

Region: South Africa

Case: Ivey W19785 Rowing South Africa: Leadership Lessons through Sport

Questions for the case:

1. What examples in the case show evidence of the practice of self-efficacy?
2. Analyze the case against the different building blocks of a learning organization.
3. Assess the various lessons that the case offers organizations for developing individuals and teams.
4. Evaluate the particular challenges facing athletes and rowing in South Africa. Given these challenges, how should Mabaso respond?

Session 9

Topic: Ethical Considerations in Sport

Sport: NFL

Region: USA

Case: HBS 9-815-071 The National Football League and Brain Injuries

Questions for the case:

1. Do you think that the NFL and franchise owners are meeting their obligations to employee healthy and safety? If not, should they? Explain.
2. Do you think that the NFL's and owners' responsibilities have changed now that potential long-term health risks are more widely understood?
3. Do you think that the changes made in terms of rules, equipment, and player health assessment to date have been sufficient?
4. If you were the owner of an NFL franchise team, would you look to sell your team, or do you think the NFL will continue as a viable and profitable business?

Note: Make sure to read the case Appendix

Session 10

Topic: Team Globalization

Sport: Soccer

Region: Europe

Case: HBS 9-723-391 The Globalization of Manchester City Football Group

Questions for the case:

1. What are the potential benefits and risks of going global by acquiring clubs in the soccer business?
2. Do you think the benefits outweigh the risks? If so, why haven't other soccer clubs expanded globally through acquisitions?
3. Should Ferran buy Bahia?

Jan.